

Course Schedule

Week 1 (January 12, 2026)

Module 1

Mon. Jan 12th - Fri. Jan 16th.

Topics

- **Introductory Remarks**
- **Understanding Human Sexuality: Moral/Ideological Perspectives**

This module will examine:

1. **The importance of applying relevant concepts and theories to the study of human sexuality.**
2. **The ways in which ideology influences our attitudes and beliefs about human sexuality.**
3. **The differences between the Restrictive and Permissive sexual ideologies.**

Required Readings

- **Read Course Module 1: Introductory Remarks & Understanding Human Sexuality: Moral/Ideological Perspectives**

Assignments

N/A

Tests/Exams

N/A

Week 2 (January 17, 2026)

Module 2

Sat. Jan 17th - Fri. Jan 23rd.

Topics

- **Understanding Human Sexuality: Theoretical Perspectives**

This module will examine:

1. The importance of theory in understanding, explaining, and predicting sexual behaviour and attitudes.
2. The major theoretical perspectives used in the study of human sexuality.
3. The differences between essentialist and social constructionist theories of human sexuality.

Required Readings

- Read Course Module 2: Understanding Human Sexuality: Theoretical Perspectives
- *Human Sexuality in a World of Diversity, 7th Canadian Edition*. Chapter 2 (Only read the first section: LO 2.: Theoretical Approaches to Understanding Human Sexuality).

Assignments

N/A

Tests/Exams

N/A

Week 3 (January 24, 2026)

Module 3

Sat. Jan 24th - Fri Jan 30th (Poll 1 is due Fri Jan 30th, 11:59PM)

Topics

Sexual Diversity In and Across Cultures

This module will examine:

1. How Restrictive sexual ideology has served to mask sexual diversity in Western culture.
2. Cross-cultural differences in attitudes and behaviours related to sexual techniques, masturbation, sexual orientation, female sexuality, premarital sex, etc.
3. The extent to which social class, ethnicity, region and other factors contribute to sexual diversity in Canada.

4. The importance of incorporating an awareness of sexual diversity into sexual health promotion programming.

Required Readings

- Read Course Module 3: Sexual Diversity In and Across Cultures
- *Human Sexuality in a World of Diversity, 7th Canadian Edition*, Chapter 1

Assignments

Complete and submit Review Poll #1

Tests/Exams

N/A

Week 4 (January 31, 2026)

Module 4

Sat. Jan 31st - Fri. Feb 6th.

Sexuality and Gender

This module will examine:

1. The concepts of sex, gender, gender identity, and gender role.
2. The relative contributions of biology and environment in the development of gender and gender roles related to sexuality.
3. The ways in which gender role socialization contributes to gender differences in sexuality.
4. The ways that the traditional sexual script for sexual interactions contributes to gender inequality.
5. Transgender/trans health and identity development.

Required Readings

- Read Course Module 4: Sexuality and Gender
- *Human Sexuality in a World of Diversity, 7th Canadian Edition*, Chapter 5

N/A

Tests/Exams

N/A

Week 5 (February 7, 2026)

Module 5

Sat. Feb 7th - Fri. Feb 13th (Poll 2 is due Fri. Feb 13th, 11:59PM)

Topics

Sexual Orientation and the Coming Out Process

This module will examine:

1. The changing attitudes of Canadians about sexual orientation.
2. The major obstacles faced by gay, lesbian, and bisexual youth and adults.
3. The six stages of gay, lesbian, and bisexual identity development.
4. The four dimensions of the coming out process.

Required Readings

- Read Course Module 5: Sexual Orientation: Identity Development and the Coming Out Process.
- *Human Sexuality in a World of Diversity 7th Canadian Edition*, Chapter 9.

Assignments

Complete and submit Review Poll #2

Tests/Exams

N/A

Review Week (February 14, 2026)

There are no learning sessions this week. You may use this time to review course materials.

Week 6 (February 21, 2026)

Module 6

Sat. Feb 21st - Feb 27th.

Topics

Childhood Sexuality

This module will examine:

- 1. Societal attitudes towards childhood sexuality and sexual behaviour.**
- 2. The key developmental tasks related to sexuality for children aged 0-2, 2-5, 5-8, and 9-12.**
- 3. Common sexual behaviours among children at different ages.**

Required Readings

- Read Course Module 6: Childhood Sexuality**
- *Human Sexuality in a World of Diversity, 7th Canadian Edition*, Chapter 12, (Only read the first section, LO 12.1 The Development of Childhood Sexuality).**

Assignments

N/A

Tests/Exams

N/A

Week 7 (February 28, 2026)

Module 7

Sat. Feb 28th - Fri. March 6th (Essay 1 is due Friday March 6th, 11:59PM)

Topics

Essay Assignment 1

Required Readings

N/A

Assignments

Submit Essay Assignment

Tests/Exams

N/A

Week 8 (March 7, 2026)

Module 8

Sat. March 7th - Fri. March 13th

Topics

- Adolescent Sexuality: Part 1

Part 1 will examine:

1. Societal attitudes towards adolescent sexuality and sexual behaviour.
2. Key developmental tasks related to sexuality for adolescents.
3. Patterns of sexual behaviour during the adolescent years.
4. Societal influences on adolescent sexuality.

- Adolescent Sexuality: Part 2

Part 2 will examine:

1. Ideological perspectives towards sexuality education in the schools.
2. Canadian's attitudes towards sexuality education in the schools.
3. Adolescent's needs with respect to sexuality education.
4. Key ingredients of effective adolescent sexuality education programs.

Required Readings

Read Course Module 8: Adolescent Sexuality Parts 1 & 2

Human Sexuality in a World of Diversity, 7th Canadian Edition, Chapter 12, (Read only LO 12.2 Adolescent Sexuality) and Chapter 15.

Assignments

N/A

Tests/Exams

N/A

Week 9 (March 14, 2026)

Module 9

Sat. March 14th - Fri. March 20th (Poll 3 is due Fri. March 20th, 11:59PM)

Topics

Adult Sexuality

This module will examine:

- 1. Historical shifts in attitudes towards the role of sexuality in achieving individual and couple happiness.**
- 2. The key developmental tasks of adult sexuality.**
- 3. The prevalence, causes, and treatment of common male and female problems and sexual dysfunctions.**

Required Readings

Read Course Module 9: Adult Sexuality

- *Human Sexuality in a World of Diversity 7th Canadian Edition*, Chapter 12, (Read only LO 12.4 : Adult Sexuality and relationships) and Chapter 13.**

Assignments

Complete and Submit Review Poll # 3

Tests/Exams

N/A

Week 10 (March 21, 2026)

Module 10

Sat. March 21st - Fri. March 27th.

Topics

- Sexuality in Later Life**

This module will examine:

- 1. Societal attitudes towards the sexuality of older adults.**
- 2. The sexuality and sexual behaviour of older adults.**
- 3. The key developmental tasks related to the sexuality of older adults.**
- 4. The obstacles to sexual expression faced by nursing home residents.**

Required Readings

- Read Course Module 10: Sexuality in Later Life**

- ***Human Sexuality in a World of Diversity 7th Canadian Edition, Chapter 12, (Read only LO 12.5 : Sexuality in Later Life)***

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Assignments

N/A

Tests/Exams

N/A

Week 11 (March 28, 2026)

Module 11

Sat. March 28th - Fri. April 3rd.

Topics

- **Sexuality and Disability**

This module will examine:

- 1. The ways in which societal attitudes present obstacles to the expression of people with disabilities sexuality.**
- 2. Common myths and misperceptions regarding the sexuality of people with disabilities.**
- 3. The roles health professionals can play in promoting the sexual health of people with disabilities.**

Required Readings

- **Read Course Module 12: Sexuality and Disability**
- ***Human Sexuality in a World of Diversity 7th Canadian Edition, Chapter 4, (Read only LO 4.7: Sexuality and Disability).***

and

Campbell, M. (2017). Disabilities and sexual expression: A review of the literature. *Sociology Compass*, 11: e12508.

<https://onlinelibrary-wiley-com.ezproxy.lib.torontomu.ca/doi/pdf/10.1111/soc4.12508>

or

Giles, M. L., Juando-Prats, C., McPherson, A. C., & Gesink, D. (2023). "But, you're in a wheelchair!": A systematic review exploring the sexuality of youth with physical disabilities. *Sexuality and Disability*, 41(2), 141–171. <https://link-springer-com.ezproxy.lib.torontomu.ca/content/pdf/10.1007/s11195-022-09769-5>

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Assignments

N/A

Tests/Exams

N/A

Week 12 (April 4, 2026)

Module 12

Sat. April 4th - Fri. April 10th (Poll 4 is due Fri. April 10th, 11:59PM)

Topics

- Principles of Sexual Health Promotion

This module will examine:

1. The roles of Information, Motivation, and Behavioural Skills (IMB Model) in changing sexual health related behaviour.
2. The roles of Elicitation, Intervention, and Evaluation in applying the IMB model to sexual health promotion programs.
3. Opportunities for further professional development in the area of human sexuality.

Required Readings

- SIECCAN. (2019). *Canadian Guidelines for Sexual Health Education*. Toronto, ON: Sex Information and Education Council of Canada. (Only read pp. 36-50) https://www.sieccan.org/files/ugd/1332d5_e3ee36e39d944009956af5b86f0a5ed6.pdf(Opens PDF document)

Assignments

Complete and submit Review Poll #4

Tests/Exams

N/A

Week 13 (April 11, 2026)

Module 13

Sat. April 11th - Fri April 17th (Essay 2 is due Fri April 17th, 11:59PM)

Assignments

Submit Essay Assignment

Tests/Exams

N/A

Please Note

Note: All times specified in this course are Eastern Time (GMT-05:00). Students in other time zones should account for the difference between Eastern Time and their own local time when submitting Assignments or attempting Tests or Exams.